

06-24-2025 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mfjPVRcedsE
Publication Date	2025-06-25T09:35:05Z
Target Category	mcs

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Municipal Meeting Report: Muncie Community Schools Board of Education

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(No statutory public hearing or committee session was held prior to the regular meeting; this section is omitted pursuant to instructions.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order at [00:01:50](#) by the presiding officer. Opening procedures included a moment of silence and the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Mr. Peter, Mrs. Watasha Barnes Griffin, Mr. Low, Mrs. Washburn, and the presiding officer.
 - **Absent:** Mr. Williams, Mr. Irvin.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Opening moment of silence and Pledge of Allegiance 00:01:50. Introduction of newly hired teachers/staff (Sydney, fourth-grade teacher at East Washington Academy; Eric Curts, PE teacher at East Washington Academy; Stephanie Curtain, middle school math instructional coach; and Cedric Anderson, alternative teacher at North Side, joined by his family) 00:06:56.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** *(Not explicitly detailed in the transcript text).*
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:11:03 Curriculum Adoption: Megawords Reading Intervention**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mrs. Pulp Meek.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presentation of a request to adopt the “Megawords” curriculum as a Tier 2 reading intervention for middle school students, aligning with the science of reading. The program focuses on explicit word recognition, syllabication, prefixes, and suffixes. Funded in conjunction with a \$50,000 digital intervention grant and support from Marian University. Cost: \$9,700.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:15:31.
- **00:15:45 Financial Update (May Financial Report & Senate Bill 1 Discussion)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome (Chief Financial Officer / Financial Staff).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Monthly financial review noting an expected \$47.8 million in revenue, an end-of-May overall fund cash balance just under \$35 million, and a state loan reduced to \$7 million (paying \$180,000 monthly). Property tax distribution of \$4.6 million received, with \$4.3 million allocated for long-term debt/bonds. Discussion regarding the \$19.8 million construction project passing legal waiting periods, with upcoming bond sales expected in Q4 2025 for fieldhouse HVAC/boiler updates, roofing, chillers, bleachers, and exterior doors. Extensive board discussion regarding the local and state impact of Senate Bill 1 and property tax caps.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:27:54.
- **00:28:03 Policy Updates (July 1 Legislative Compliance)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration / Church Hill and Antrum (Legal Counsel).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of necessary policy updates to comply with new Indiana codes and laws effective July 1. Updates cover non-discrimination/anti-harassment language, school attendance definitions and excused absences, parent access and mandatory state permission slips (House Bill 1315), repeal of the teacher appreciation grant policy, religious release time, purchasing/capital asset

procedures (capitalization minimum set at \$10,000), and audio/video recordings. Board moved to waive the second reading and approve directly.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Second reading waived) 00:32:02.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- No general public comments were brought forward during the open public comment period 00:06:44.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Dr. Reynolds provided operational updates regarding central campus concrete work, the summer marching band schedule, elementary i3 testing results, the Camp Adventure nature-based pre-K/kindergarten Montessori program (at full capacity with 20 children), a partnership with Thrive Credit Union for MCS Bearcat branded debit cards, and a \$50,000 digital intervention grant for middle school reading.
 - Next month's meetings and budget presentations (including the August budget presentation) were noted.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was adjourned by voice vote following a motion and second 00:32:36.